

Salary Guide for Lawyers

UAE, 2026 edition



Monthly base salary in AED, excluding bonus and allowances. In private practice, excluding equity and profit share.

Private Practice

LEVEL	STANDARD	STRONG	EXCEPTIONAL
Managing Partner	142k–191k	176k–237k	215k–289k
Partner	103k–139k	159k–215k	188k–254k
Counsel	83k–113k	104k–141k	127k–172k
Senior Associate	45k–60k	61k–82k	72k–97k
Associate	32k–43k	49k–67k	58k–79k
Newly Qualified	25k–34k	38k–51k	45k–60k

In-House

LEVEL	STANDARD	STRONG	EXCEPTIONAL
Chief Legal Officer	95k–128k	118k–159k	152k–204k
General Counsel	88k–119k	107k–145k	131k–177k
Senior Counsel / Deputy GC	54k–72k	66k–89k	78k–105k
Legal Counsel	35k–48k	43k–58k	51k–68k
Junior Legal Counsel	25k–34k	30k–41k	37k–50k

Compliance

LEVEL	STANDARD	STRONG	EXCEPTIONAL
Head of Compliance / CCO	82k–110k	102k–137k	124k–167k
Director / MLRO	63k–85k	80k–107k	94k–127k
Senior Manager / VP	46k–63k	58k–79k	69k–93k
Compliance Manager	30k–40k	42k–56k	49k–66k
Senior Compliance Officer	22k–30k	27k–36k	32k–43k

The rest of the package

HOUSING

Often 20 to 30 per cent of base, or a set allowance; sometimes rolled into a single all-in figure.

BONUS

In-house typically 10 to 25 per cent of base. Partners earn through profit share; associate bonuses vary by firm.

MEDICAL AND FLIGHTS

Family medical cover is standard. Annual home flights are no longer a given and vary by employer.

Packages in the GCC can vary dependent on sector, country and team. For an accurate view on your current package and expectations, please reach out to our team for a confidential discussion.